

rolls Willpower (difficulty 8); sometimes, as with pooka, this also requires spending a point of Willpower. Remember that if the expenditure is necessary, then it sends a message to the player that avoiding the Frailty is possible, but only when it's truly significant to the plot of the story.

Curses

Curse Frailties are supernatural weaknesses. Trolls grow sick and weak if they break their word. Selkies can be controlled or even killed if their seal coats are destroyed. If the Frailty involves the character suffering some mechanical penalty or consequence as a result of breaking a taboo or being outwitted in some way, it's a Curse (note the essential difference between a Curse and a Compulsion: Compulsions generally don't have consequences, and characters can *usually* get around them, at least temporarily. Curses don't come up as often, but when they do they're important and dramatic).

Curses don't necessarily have to cause Health levels of damage (and in fact they probably shouldn't; see above), but they can reduce a character's efficacy or make the character sick or weak for a time. If you choose to use this kind of Frailty, it's best to give the character a way to avoid it or cure it — succumbing to the Frailty shouldn't be something that the Storyteller just has *happen* to the character.

Ineptitude

Ineptitude Frailties are rare; much like Acuity Birthrights, they affect the character's acumen at certain tasks. Redcaps just aren't very good in social situations, and they take penalties to navigate them, for instance. Ineptitude Frailties can reduce dice pools, increase difficulties, or, in extreme cases, cause the character to automatically fail at certain actions.

Ineptitude Frailties should be used carefully; by themselves, they don't lend much to drama. Instead, they tend to highlight types of actions the kith should just avoid. A skilled Storyteller and a brave player can get some interesting scenes out of the character trying to deal with situations for which she is categorically unfit, but that's unsatisfying over repeated chapters and it's probably depriving some other character of a chance to shine. An Ineptitude can, however, be an interesting addition to an otherwise mild Frailty.

Step Five: Affinity

Choose a Realm to act as the kith's Affinity Realm. This means that the player receives a -1 to the difficulty of any cantrip using this Realm as the primary Realm. Choose whichever Realm feels appropriate, but here are a few guidelines:

- ☉ Choose **Actor** if the kith is highly tied in to mortal communities, or if one of its Birthrights involves mortals or Dreamers directly.
- ☉ Choose **Fae** if the kith is overtly and obviously magical, or if it has a specific historical tie-in to Kithain society.
- ☉ Choose **Nature** if the kith is clearly tied to the outdoors, to animals, or to classical elements.

- ☉ Choose **Prop** if the kith works with objects or crafting, or is prone to theft.
- ☉ Choose **Scene** if the kith is focused on travel or movement.
- ☉ Choose **Time** if the kith has a mythological reputation for immortality or eternal youth.

Step Six: Adjust as Necessary

The last step in creating a new kith is in many ways the most important. Look over all the work you've done, all of the history you've created, and Birthrights and Frailty you've designed, and ask yourself: Is this right? Is this what you wanted? Is this kith going to be *fun* to play? The Storyteller should have some input here, but you're the one who's going to be responsible for bringing the kith into the world of **Changeling**, so the final decision rests with you: Do you need to adjust anything to make the kith work as you envisioned?

If you need to adjust something, do it. Don't be afraid to break the rules as we've defined them here (they're more like guidelines, anyway). If you've designed a Frailty that you really like, but you picture the kith as starting to bleed when it comes into play, maybe it inflicts a Health level of chimerical damage. Yes, the advice says to avoid direct damage, but like all of the rules in **Changeling**, it's a suggestion. If you've come up with a Birthright that uses a system that takes elements of Magic and Acumen, use it! Just clear it with your Storyteller and make sure you're not breaking anything she'd prefer to leave intact, and you're ready to go.

Example of Kith Creation

Matt is getting ready to play in his brother's **Changeling** game, and is considering his options for a character. Knowing that the game is going to focus on the relationship between changelings and mundane people, he wants to play a character with a strong connection to humanity. In particular, he's interested in boggans, but their focus on mundane tasks leaves him a little cold — his tastes run to more visceral, magical characters. He asks the Storyteller if he can create a kith instead.

Step One: Concept

Doing a bit of research, Matt discovers the *domovoi*, protective house spirits common to Russian and Slavic myth. Domovoi have a number of different stories attached to them — they sometimes did housework or mundane tasks for their adopted families, like boggans, but unlike boggans they watched over people as they slept and acted as oracles for them. If they became angry with their family, they were also said to lash out like poltergeists. Matt enjoys this dichotomy and gets to work bringing the domovoi into **Changeling**.

Domovoi are described in folklore as being small, stunted, and hairy. Matt decides that in **Changeling**, that should still hold true — the domovoi kith are short, and tend towards having dark, profuse body hair. They aren't ugly, necessarily, but are definitely swarthy and somewhat coarse. For all that, they move with grace and deftness, and Matt feels they should walk almost silently (since they need to creep around houses at